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What a Request Looks Like on Your Phone

The texts you'll get during a response, and what to do with each

Updated **October 12, 2026**

Official requests

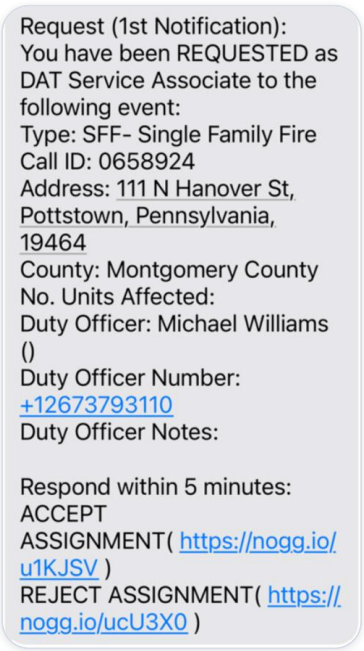
This guide covers requests sent through the RC Respond system. Each text has links you tap as the response moves along.

Plain texts count too

Sometimes a Duty Officer (DO) texts you directly, with no links. Those are real requests too: just text back the DO who sent it.

Requested accept or reject → **Assigned** still wait → **On Scene** you arrived → **Off Scene** heading home → **Complete** safely home

1



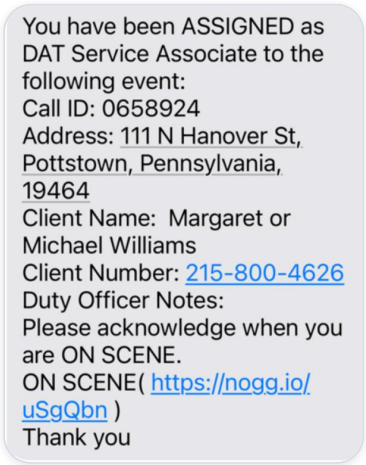
Requested: the first text

The address is clickable and opens your phone's maps app for an ETA and directions. The DO's name and number are in the middle. To talk to them, call or text **that number**; don't reply to this text.

Tap **Accept** to tell the DO you are available. **This does not necessarily mean you are going.** When the DO has a full team, they send a group text to everyone going.

> **Can't go?** Don't feel guilty. Tap Reject so your name drops off the DO's screen. No one will be mad at you.

2



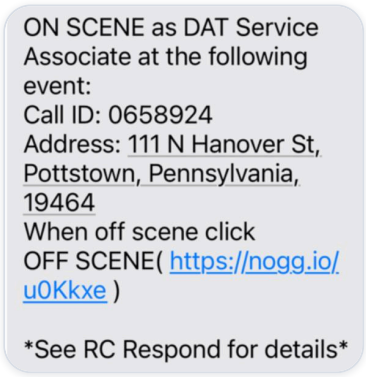
Assigned: still wait

This one is a little tricky. It may arrive right after you tap Accept, and it sounds like you should head out.

> **Assigned does not mean go.** It only means the DO has flagged you as part of the team. They may still be looking for more people.

Wait for a group text with you and at least one other responder. Once you have all shared ETAs and agreed on a time and place, head out. When you arrive, tap **On Scene**.

3

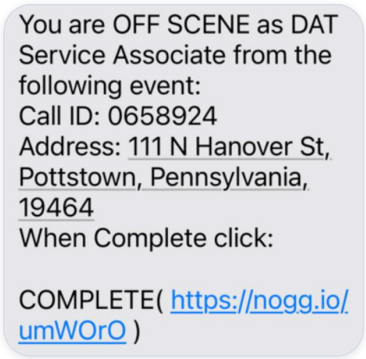


On Scene: help your client

As soon as you tap On Scene, this text comes back. Now help your client.

When you are done and **everyone on your team** is ready to leave, tap **Off Scene** so the DO knows you are heading home.

4



Off Scene: tap Complete when home

This text arrives right after you tap Off Scene. Once you are home, or finished with Red Cross business (say you stop for groceries), you **must** tap **Complete**.

> **Why it matters:** the DO cannot close the case until every responder is Complete. In human terms, they can't go to bed until they know you are safely home.

That's the full life cycle of a response.

If a request comes without links, reach out to the DO who sent it. They will add you to the system and all of the texts above will follow.

Thank you for all you do!